

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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GENTLENESS

OUR FOCUS: GENTLE - GENTLENESS

Preamble:

I have been reflecting on this word “gentleness” and thought it would be good to take a little time to look at its use in scripture and its relevant application to the believer today.

‘Gentleness’ is not weakness it is that quality of character that is strong and exhibits strength not weakness.

‘Gentleness’ is something that is to be sought after and exhibited by every believer.

Gentleness, meekness, mildness, humility – is to be practiced amongst us in our relationships with one another.

OUR TEXTS

2 Samuel 22:36 Thou hast also given me the shield of thy salvation: and thy gentleness hath made me great. KJV

2 Corinthians 10:1 Now I Paul myself beseech you by the meekness and gentleness of Christ, who in presence am base among you, but being absent am bold toward you: KJV

Gentleness - NT:1932 - GREEK> epieikeia (ep-ee-i'-ki-ah); from NT:1933; suitableness, i.e. (by implication) equity, mildness:

KJV - clemency, gentleness

GENTLENESS, MEEKNESS, MILDNESS, HUMILITY is to be PRACTICED amongst us:

1. IN OUR RELATIONSHIPS WITH ONE ANOTHER - (how we deal and treat one another – compassionate and kindly etc.)
2. IN OUR PRESENTATION OF THE GOSPEL – (in our approach and telling the good news (with gentleness, firmness but not harshness)
3. IN OUR OWN DEVELOPMENT AND GROWTH IN CHRIST (always desiring to see this quality of gentleness growing and present in our lives)

THE APOSTLE

2 Corinthians 10:1 Now I Paul myself beseech you by the meekness and gentleness of Christ, who in presence am base among you, but being absent am bold toward you: KJV

NT:1932 - KJV clemency, gentleness. - gentle, moderation, patient. [Strong's Concordance]

The mild and humble manner in which the blessed apostle addresses the Corinthians, and how desirous he is that no occasion may be given him to use severity. [but by the meekness and gentleness of Christ]

In view of the meekness and mildness of the Jesus he desired to imitate his gentleness and kindness.

Meekness - NT:4240 - Greek> prautes (prah-oo'-tace); from NT:4239; mildness, i.e. (by implication) humility: - KJV - meekness.

ALL BELIEVERS

Galatians 5:22 But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, **gentleness**, goodness, faith, KJV

NT:5544 KJV - **gentleness, good (-ness), kindness. Strong's Concordance**

JESUS - AS THE SHEPHERD

Isaiah 40:11 He shall feed his flock like a shepherd: he shall **gather the lambs with his arm**, and **carry them in his bosom**, and **shall gently lead** those that are with young. KJV

2 Timothy 2:24-25

24 And the servant of the Lord must not strive; but **be gentle** unto all men, apt to teach, patient, **25 In meekness** instructing those that oppose themselves; if God peradventure will give them repentance to the acknowledging of the truth; KJV

Titus 3:2 To speak evil of no man, to be no brawlers, **but gentle**, shewing all **meekness** unto all men. KJV

THE APOSTLE AS A NURSING MOTHER

1 Thessalonians 2:7-8, 11-12

7 but we were **gentle** among you, **like a mother caring for her little children**.

8 **We loved you so much** that we were delighted to share with you not only the gospel of God but our lives as well, **because you had become so dear to us**.

11 For you know that we dealt with each of you **as a father deals with his own children**,

12 **encouraging, comforting and urging** you to live lives worthy of God, who calls you into his kingdom and glory. NIV

1. HIS GENTLENESS.

GENTLENESS

Psalms 18:35 Thou hast also given me the shield of thy salvation: and thy right hand hath holden me up, and **thy gentleness hath made me great**. KJV

2 Samuel 22:36 Thou hast also given me the shield of thy salvation: **and thy gentleness hath made me great**. KJV

STOOPED DOWN – bent down

2 Samuel 22:36 You give me your shield of victory; **you stoop down** to make me great. NIV

CONDESCENSION – coming down

2 Samuel 22:36 You have also given me the shield of Your salvation; and **Your condescension and gentleness** have made me great. AMP

LOWLINESS - Humility

2 Samuel 22:36 And Thou givest to me the shield of Thy salvation, **And Thy lowliness** maketh me great. YLT

THIS GENTLENESS SPOKEN OF HERE IS A REFERENCE TO CHRIST'S CONDESCENSION.

CHRIST'S CONDESCENSION

- **His coming down** to earth to die for sinners
- **He STOOPED down – he reached down** and in reaching down he made us great; he made us somebody.
- He made us brand new people.
- He reached down and **lifted us up** to greater heights.
- **He restored** our lost dignity, took away the shame and gave us an identity that had value and worth.
- He placed us on a solid foundation (the Rock – Christ) and put a new song in our hearts of praise to our God.
- I am forever thankful that he showed his gentleness – **by 'stooped down'** for me.
- It was his **LOWLINESS** – humbling himself – taking on the form of a servant etc. (Philippians 2)
- So, his gentleness referred to his redemptive work on the Cross that produced the new persons that we are in Christ.
- creation his stooping down.
- What a wonderful story and to think that the redemptive work of Christ was 'hidden' (veiled) in the Old Testament.

Amen - Ps Barry